

agenda for the next assembly polls. Playing with people's emotions always pays rich rewards: in politics, it guarantees power too.

DR KARANAMRAO,

via www.indiatoday.in

Politicians of all hues, hailing from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, are taking potshots at each other for having failed to protect north Indians in Maharashtra ("Dividing the Nation", November 10). But will they ever realise that they are to some extent responsible for the current state of affairs? If they had taken interest in the welfare of their people and ensured good living standards, provided better job opportunities and prospects of a bright future, no one from these states would have moved out in search of greener pastures.

RAJEEV KUMAR PANDAY,

via www.indiatoday.in

Innocence Lost

It is not so much the custom to be blamed for child marriage, as is the poverty and selfishness of parents who force their children to marry and then face the rigours of widowhood ("Widowed Children", November 10). To check this evil practice from spreading its tentacles, the state governments must be firm in implementing harsher punishments for those found guilty. The NGOs also need to play an active role in spreading aware-

ness against this malaise at the grassroots level.

COL. R.D. SINGH,

via www.indiatoday.in

Sinful Thinking

Live-in relationships, for all their inflexion of modernity, are founded on convenience rather than conviction ("Never Married", November 3). Practitioners of this kind of social life should bear its consequences—good, bad or ugly. Judicial or legislative

request for Incredible India road shows abroad, especially those planned in Russia and Central Asian Republics in August/September 2008, the Ministry of Tourism would like to clarify that these shows were postponed by the ministry in line with austerity measures announced by the prime minister. The proposal for the road shows was not sent for clearance to any other



“The involvement of religious groups in terror activities hints at the larger picture, often unseen and unheard, of the role that power and politics play in the scheme of things.”

V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

attention would make it a way of life, thereby corrupting the social fabric.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY,

via www.indiatoday.in

Show Pause

Apropos of your news item ("Incredible Halt", November 17) on the Prime Minister's Office (PMO) rejecting the

ministry, including the PMO. It is further clarified that promotional events and activities in overseas tourist generating markets are continuing as scheduled and no event has been cancelled by the PMO to date.

ALOK DESHWAL,

Press Information Bureau,

Ministry of Tourism and Culture

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30
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Jag-Bomb

Mrs Gandhi's daughter-in-law Maneka Gandhi's persistent tilting at the political windmills may be as jingoistic as Don Quixote's was, but in her case it has the desired effect. The last issue of her *Surya* magazine carried an exposé on the alleged unsavoury manipulations in the recent purchase of Jaguar aircraft by India. According to the story, the Rs 1,623-crore Jaguar deal was put through with the help of slush funds slipped into the palms of Defence Minister Jagjivan Ram through his amorous son Suresh by an arms dealer called S.P. Chibber, whom *Surya* described as the Indian representative of British counterpart of the Anglo-French company that produces Jaguars. *Surya's* article, however, was convincing, and even the subsequent denials by British Aerospace and by Jagjivan Ram failed to diffuse the outraged reaction to the allegations.

